Terms of engagement

These terms apply to physiotherapy provided by Community Care Physio (Zakery Shelley, HCPC PH132358) where a case manager, insurer, care provider or other organisation ("you") instructs and pays for the work. They go with our written quote, and confirming the quote in writing is acceptance of them. Private self-funding clients are covered by our website terms instead.

1 Instruction and acceptance
Work starts when you confirm the quote in writing. We say at acknowledgement whether we can accept a referral, and may decline where needs are outside our scope or the timescales cannot be met.

2 Assessment first
The initial assessment and report are chargeable whether or not treatment follows. If the assessment shows the client's needs are outside our scope, the report says so with onward recommendations and we decline further treatment.

3 Treatment on approval
Treatment begins only after you approve the costed plan in the assessment report. Changes to the number or frequency of sessions are agreed with you in writing first.

4 Fees
As set out in the quote. Standard or complex-needs rate is agreed before the first visit and is not increased afterwards. Travel outside the core area is charged per visit at the quoted band. VAT not applicable.

5 Invoicing and payment
Invoices go to your organisation, itemised by visit date with your case reference and PO number, monthly in arrears or per report. BACS within 30 days. Treatment may be paused where an invoice is over 30 days overdue, with notice to you and the client.

6 Cancellations
Visits cancelled with less than 24 hours' notice, or where the client is not available at the agreed time, are charged at the session fee. No charge where the cancellation is ours.

7 Timescales
Acknowledgement within 1 working day; initial assessment within 10 working days of go-ahead; assessment report within 5 working days of the visit; progress and discharge reports within 10 working days of the review or final visit; routine email questions within 2 working days at no charge. We tell you promptly if a target cannot be met.

8 Written communication
All liaison is in writing; we do not attend meetings, case conferences or calls. Additional letters or liaison documents are charged per document as quoted.

9 Reports and records
Reports are sent as password-protected PDFs by email, with the password agreed with you at acceptance and sent by text message. Clinical records are retained for 8 years after discharge, or until a child's 25th birthday, whichever is later, under UK GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018.

10 Consent and capacity
We obtain the client's consent before assessment and before sharing information, and follow Mental Capacity Act 2005 best-interests principles where capacity is lacking. You confirm the client or their representative knows of and agrees to the referral.

11 Medical fitness and safety
Observations are taken over the first three sessions. Treatment is deferred and the GP informed where the client is not medically fit on the day. Incidents are recorded and reported to you within one working day. We may end treatment where it is no longer safe or clinically appropriate, giving written notice and recommendations.

12 Equipment and aids
Recommendations are included in reports. Walking aids may occasionally be supplied from our stock at a price agreed with you first; otherwise sourcing is for you or the client. No supplier commission.

13 Scope
Treating-therapist work only. We do not provide expert-witness or court reports, 24-hour or emergency care, hydrotherapy or gym-based rehabilitation.

14 Insurance and conduct
Professional indemnity and public liability insurance in place; certificates on request. HCPC standards and CSP code apply; complaints acknowledged within 2 working days, answered in writing within 20 working days.

15 Liability
Our liability for any claim arising from a case is limited to the fees paid for that case, except for death or personal injury caused by our negligence, or anything that cannot lawfully be limited.

16 Changes and law
These terms may be updated for new instructions; the version sent with the quote applies to that case. English law applies and the courts of England and Wales have jurisdiction.

Quote reference / client initials: _____

Accepted on behalf of (organisation, name, date):
_____